may attest to the fact that in the years leading up to it Iraq's strategic military buildup did not receive the appropriate prioritization.

The primacy given by the Mossad to Iraq's development of nonconventional capabilities yielded extraordinary achievements, both in the area of intelligence gathering and in the foiling of threats; these achievements saved Israel untold damage and casualties.

I will now say a few words about the dilemmas that concern decision makers regarding the proliferation of nonconventional technologies and weapons.

The matter of the proliferation of nonconventional weapons systems (chemical, biological, nuclear, and missile, surface-to-surface missiles in particular) is anchored in international law, under the auspices of the United Nations and the superpowers, in a long series of agreements and treaties. This has created common and fertile ground for cooperation between intelligence services, mainly Western ones, whenever a rogue state decides to develop these capabilities, in whole or in part. Counteraction against proliferation involves two elements—intelligence and prevention. The interservice cooperation on the subject was problematic where the Mossad was concerned, as there was a lack of symmetry between it and the other Western intelligence and security services on many questions, such as the priority each country attached to curbing proliferation, what resources each country was willing to allocate to the subject, whether the issue should be dealt with through overt legal means alone or also covertly, and how to tackle the issue of dual-use materials that could serve both civilian and military purposes. Another important question in counterproliferation doctrine concerned the optimal point in time for transitioning from the intelligence-gathering stage to the prevention stage. Our approach was, as a general rule, to be willing to take great risks at the intelligence-gathering stage—these risks yielded intelligence that proved useful beyond the isolated case at hand. We always aspired to obtain more intelligence than the minimum that was necessary for purposes of prevention. The operational significance of this was, of course, that we made an effort to postpone acts of prevention as much as possible in favor of gathering more intelligence, because any counteroperation put an end to the intelligence collection.

Another dilemma that arose again and again was whether preventative acts should be "blue and white" operations, that is, purely Israeli, or in